# The Golden Third – research kit

Initiative 28:28 · model version v4.59 · 1 November 2026 · CC BY 4.0 · contact tax.better@archicrowd.de

## The proposal

Taxation and social protection shared by a group of states: no euro of income taxed at more than one third (0/11/19/25/33 % in steps tied to basic needs); social contributions abolished, employers pass at least 80 % of the contributions that disappear into wages; a strong safety net (health, long-term care, minimum pension, basic needs) without premiums; a monthly transformation dividend for every adult; compulsory saving 10 % into a personal account locked until retirement; VAT as a label; legacy debt and pension promises in a common fund.

## Five reference countries, 2028 (single employee, change per month)

| Country | ½ × av. wage | 1 × av. wage | 2 × av. wage | Legacy surcharge |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Germany | +586 € | +726 € | +710 € | 15.0 % |
| France | −148 € | +276 € | +459 € | 21.3 % |
| Italy | +304 € | +412 € | +766 € | 22.3 % |
| Spain | +217 € | +321 € | +336 € | 18.3 % |
| Poland | +1,406 zł | +1,404 zł | +1,554 zł | 13.5 % |

## Method and limits

- One open chain of calculations, official statistics (Eurostat, OECD, national offices) and published surveys; every correction numbered in the log (83 so far). Country models checked against OECD Taxing Wages 2026.
- Static: no behavioural responses in labour supply, saving or migration; pass-through, avoidance and take-up as assumptions or bands. A qualitative review of behavioural effects is available.
- Three reviews commissioned by the initiative (October 2026), last covering version v4.42: calculation core confirmed, findings documented. Later changes (up to v4.59) not yet reviewed. Independent review is invited.
- Largest undocumented position: the base of company taxation where customers are.

## Figures to cite

| No. | Item | Value | Unit | Reference | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Z01 | Transformation dividend per adult (Germany) | **354** | € per month | 2028, purchasing power 2026 | adopted |
| Z02 | Transformation dividend per child (Germany) | **283** | € per month | as Z01, child share 0.8 | adopted |
| Z03 | Gain, single, gross wage € 42,000 (Germany) | **611** | € per month | 2028; pass-through 80 %, surcharge 15.0 %, compulsory saving 10 % | adopted |
| Z04 | Gain, couple with one earner and 2 children, € 42,000 (Germany) | **674** | € per month | as Z03 | adopted |
| Z05 | Working-age households better off (Germany) | **85.1** | % | 2028; synthetic microsimulation, pass-through 80 % | check |
| Z06 | All households better off (Germany) | **69.3** | % | as Z05 | check |
| Z07 | Pensioner households better off (pension rule E) | **32.2** | % | 2028, Germany | adopted |
| Z08 | Pensioner households, mean change (pension rule E) | **−121** | € per month | 2028, Germany | adopted |

| No. | Item | Value | Unit | Reference | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Z09 | Contribution to the common fund of 30 states | **5.17** | % of GDP | annual until repaid | adopted |
| Z10 | Legacy surcharge on all taxes (common rate) | **15.5** | % | fund interest 2.45 % | adopted |
| Z11 | Debt ratio of the fund, peak | **148.1** | % of GDP | in 2055 | adopted |
| Z12 | Fund fully repaid | **2098** | year | | adopted |
| Z13 | Old pension claims above the dividend (Z) | **9.42** | % of GDP | 2028, average of states | adopted |
| Z14 | Total burden, taxes and fund (Germany) | **38.7** | % of GDP | 2028; today 40.76 % (Eurostat 2024) | adopted |
| Z15 | Total burden including compulsory saving (own account) | **42.8** | % of GDP | 2028 | adopted |
| Z16 | Cost of the strong net (Germany) | **9.63** | % of GDP | 2028 | adopted |
| Z17 | Marginal burden at € 60,000: today / new 2028 (Germany) | **48.8 / 40.0** | % per additional euro | single; new without compulsory saving | check |
| Z18 | VAT label burden, factor lowest / highest income class (Germany) | **0.87 / 1.07** | relative to mean | EVS 2023 | adopted |
| Z19 | One-off price level effect of the VAT label 2028 | **1.2 to 2.1** | % | mechanical 2.47 % | check |
| Z20 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Germany) | **726** | € per month | 2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting | adopted |
| Z21 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (France) | **276** | € per month | 2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting | adopted |
| Z22 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Italy) | **412** | € per month | 2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting | adopted |
| Z23 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Spain) | **321** | € per month | 2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting | adopted |
| Z24 | Gain, single employee at the average wage (Poland) | **1,404** | zł per month | 2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting | adopted |
| Z25 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Germany) | **15** | % | converging to the common rate by 2058 | adopted |
| Z26 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (France) | **21.3** | % | converging to the common rate by 2058 | adopted |
| Z27 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Italy) | **22.3** | % | converging to the common rate by 2058 | adopted |
| Z28 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Spain) | **18.3** | % | converging to the common rate by 2058 | adopted |
| Z29 | Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Poland) | **13.5** | % | converging to the common rate by 2058 | adopted |
| Z30 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Germany) | **30.1 → 26.1** | index 0–100 | official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change | check |
| Z31 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (France) | **30.4 → 29.0** | index 0–100 | official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change | check |
| Z32 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Italy) | **31.0 → 26.9** | index 0–100 | official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change | check |
| Z33 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Spain) | **30.8 → 25.0** | index 0–100 | official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change | check |

| No. | Item | Value | Unit | Reference | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Z34 | Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Poland) | **24.9 → 18.7** | index 0–100 | official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change | check |

Origin of each figure (file and path): figures-to-cite.csv. "adopted": under the decisions of the initiative; "check": cross-check or sensitivity.

## Citation

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